Magnesium is widely distributed in vegetables and also found in all animal tissues. As magnesium is an essential part of chlorophyll, green vegetables are important sources.

Absorption and excretion

Greater part of the daily ingested dietary magnesium is absorbed from the small intestine. The major quantity of magnesium is excreted in the feces and remaining is excreted through urine.

Factors affecting absorption

1. Excess of calcium decreases the absorption of magnesium.

2. Vitamin D, parathormone and growth hormone increases the absorption of magnesium.

Deficiency

The decreased level of serum magnesium causes depression, tetany and muscular weakness.



Figure 9.9 Tetany

9.2.7. Sulphur

Sulphur is present in our body as sulphur containing amino acids such as methionine and cysteine and also as sulphate. B-complex vitamins like Thiamine and biotin contain sulphur.

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